HEAd'26

Motivation, Absenteeism, and Academic Performance

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Introduction

Predicting academic performance.

Objective and subjective indicators of academic performance.

Person-centered approach.

Intensive longitudinal data.

Aims

Identify motivational profiles in a sample of university students.

Examine relationship between motivational profiles, absenteeism, and academic activity.

Assess predictive validity of motivational profiles for academic performance.

Method

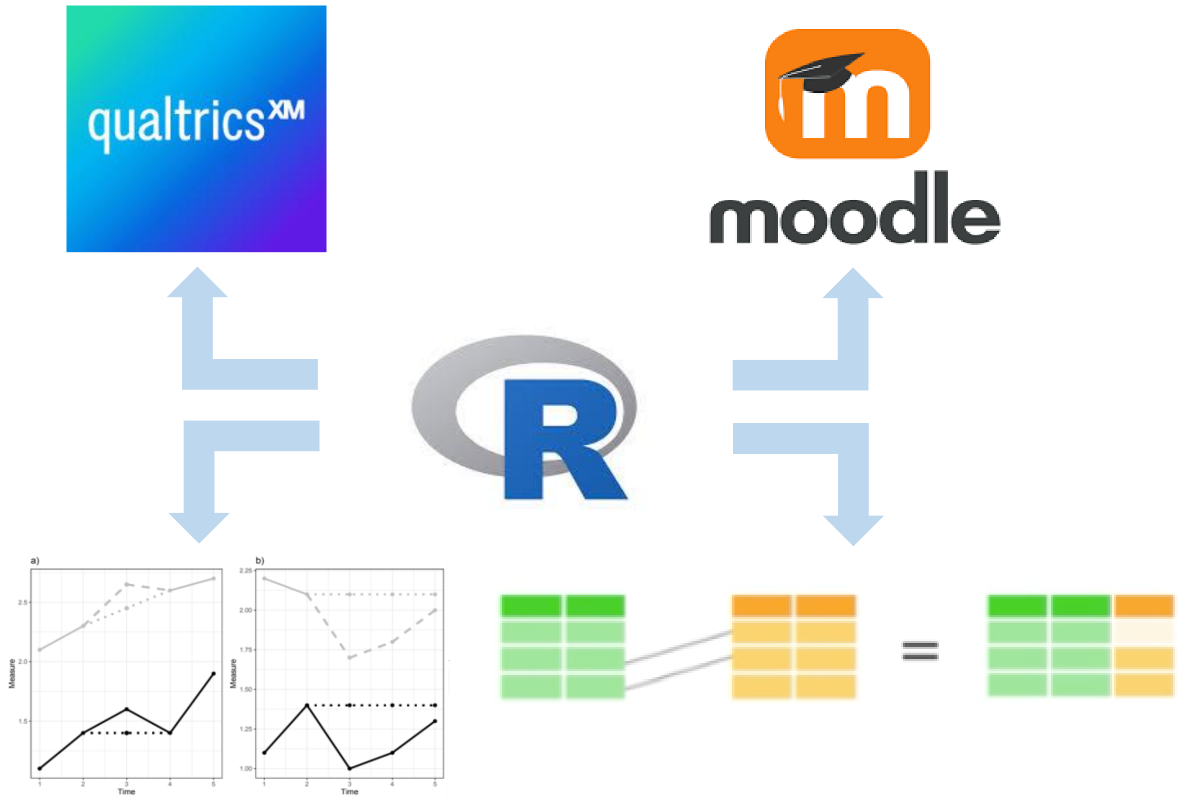
Instruments and variables

- Academic motivation scale.
- QR-based attendance monitoring in three groups.
- Reasons for absenteeism scale.
- Moodle virtual course activity logs.
- Ad-hoc perceived performance scale.
- Course final grades.

Method

Data collection

Data cleaning and imputation



Method

Profiles obtention

Statistical models

- Longitudinal k-means procedure.
- 50 iterations per solution.
- Fit indices for each solution (from 2 to 6 clusters).
- Linear mixed-effects models to describe motivational, performance, and attendance/activity profiles.
- Linear regression to predict academic performance from profiles.

Results

N =202 students.

84% women.

Age: M = 21.01, SD = 5.32.

University entrance grade: M = 10.36, SD = 1.66.

83% entered the degree program as their first choice.

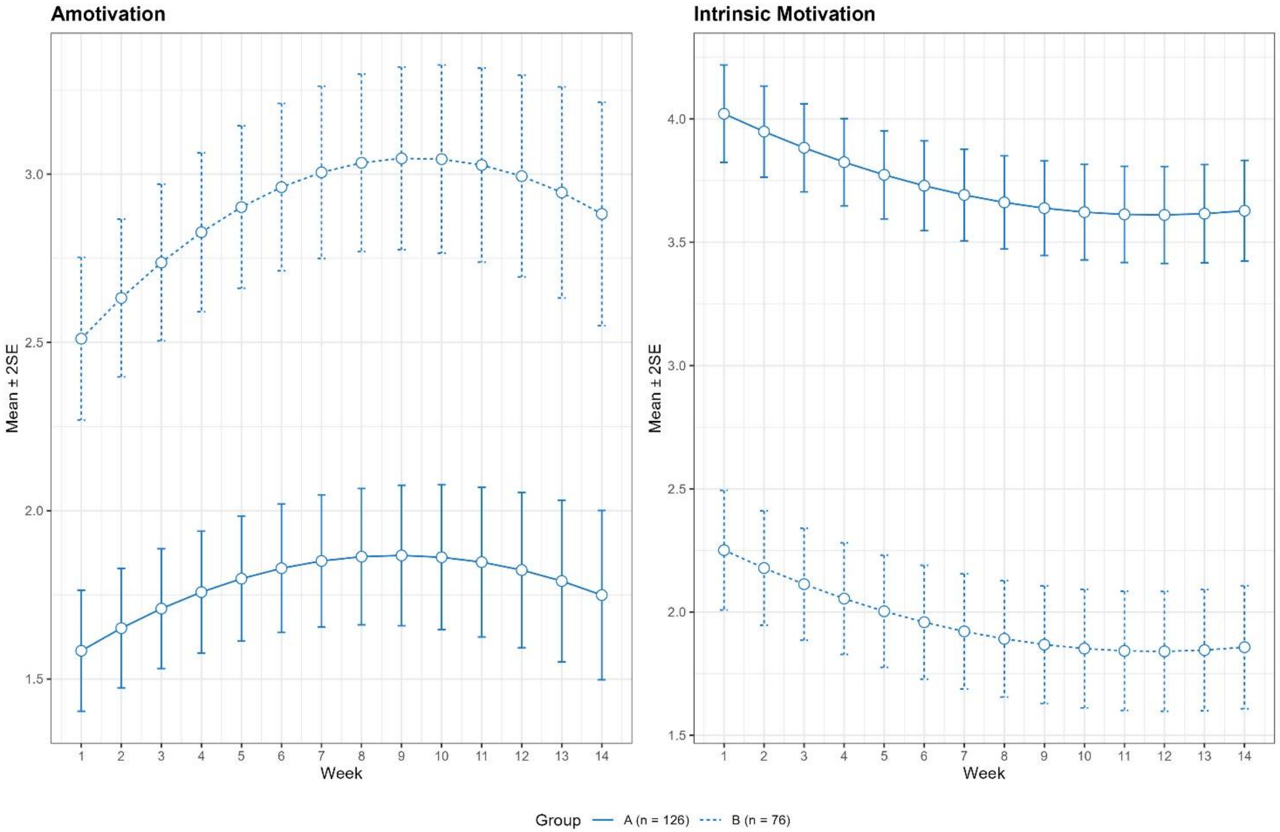
86% taking the course for the first time.

Research methods (38%), Statistics and mathematics (14%), Statistics (13%), and Organizational psychology (35%).

Results

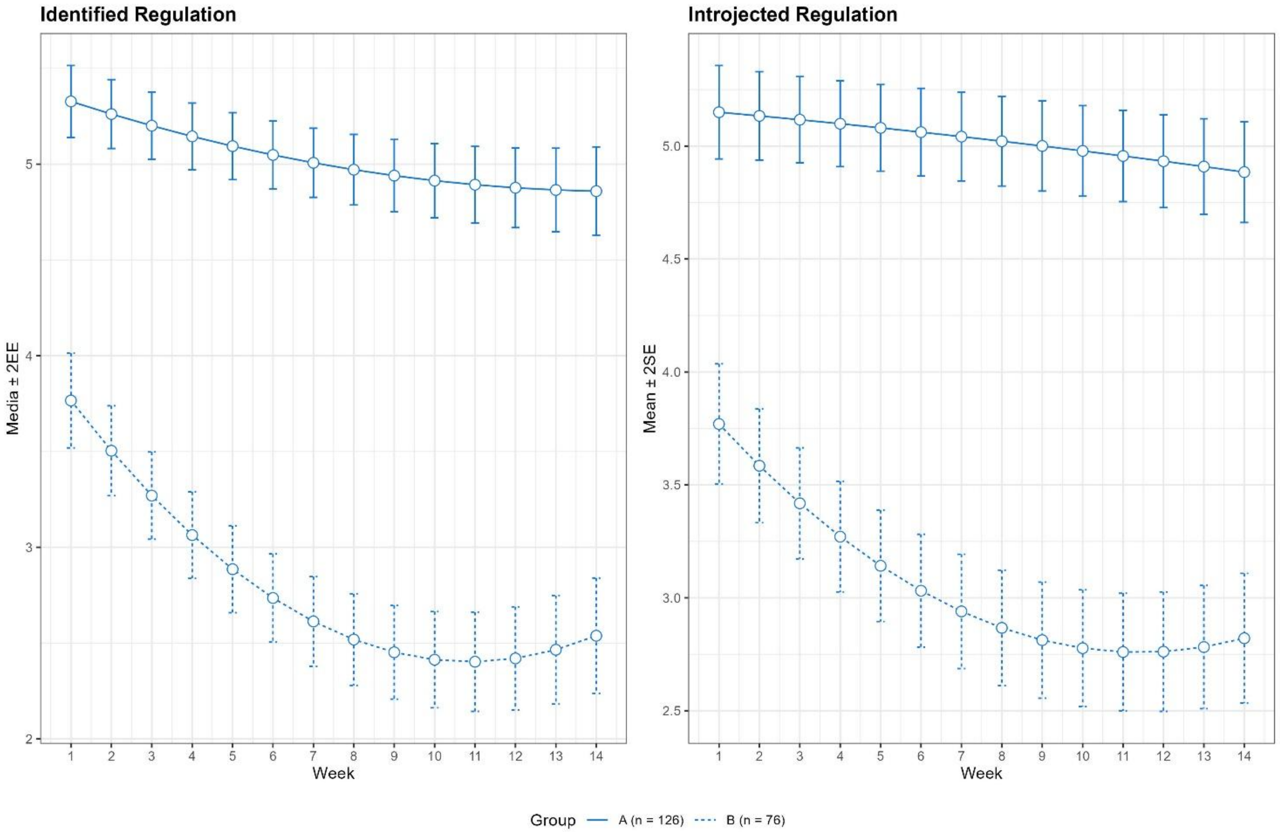
- Motivational profiles identified:

- Cluster A (n = 126): ↑ intrinsic motivation ↓ amotivation.
- Cluster B (n = 76): ↑ amotivation ↓ intrinsic motivation.



Results

- Motivational profiles identified:
- Cluster A (n = 126): ↑ forms of internal regulation.
- Cluster B (n = 76): ↓ internal regulation.



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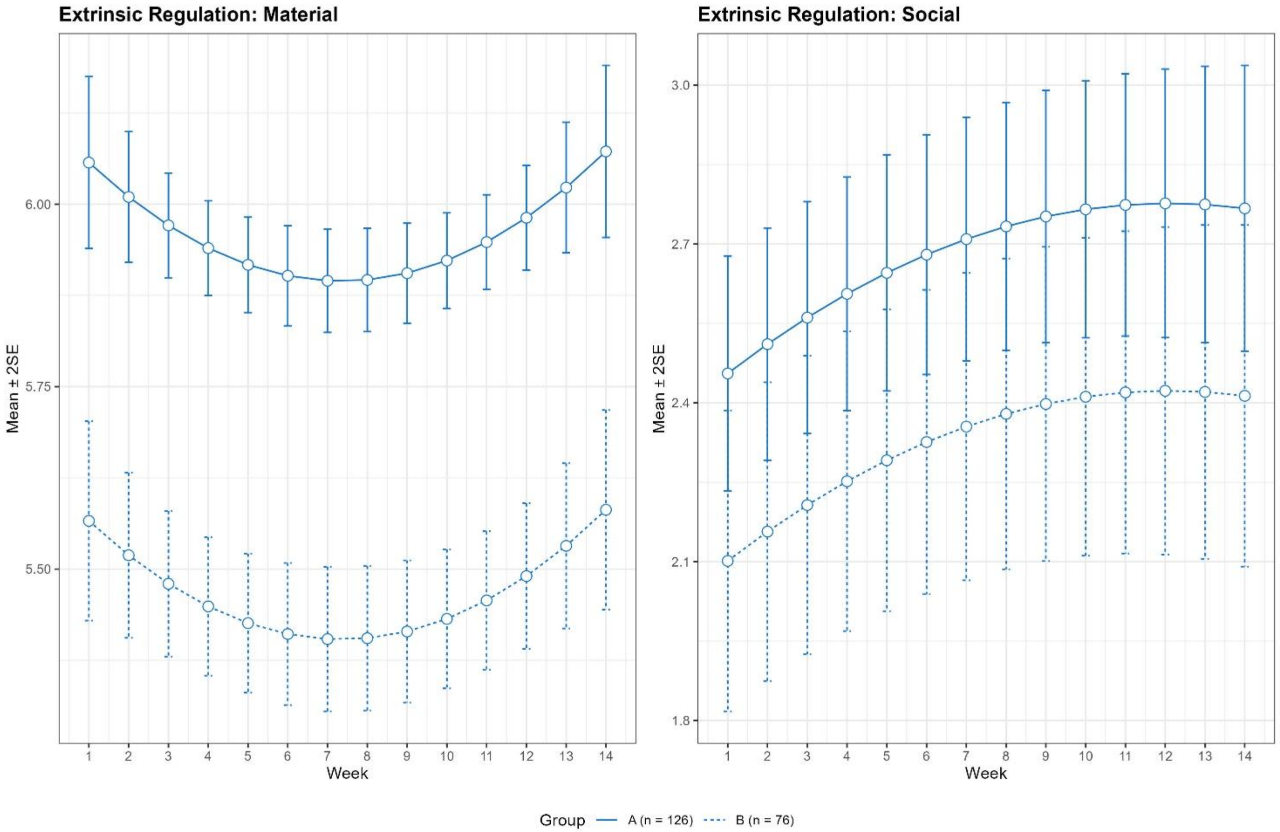
Results

- Motivational profiles identified:
- Cluster A (n = 126): ↑ external regulation.
- Cluster B (n = 76): ↓ external regulation.

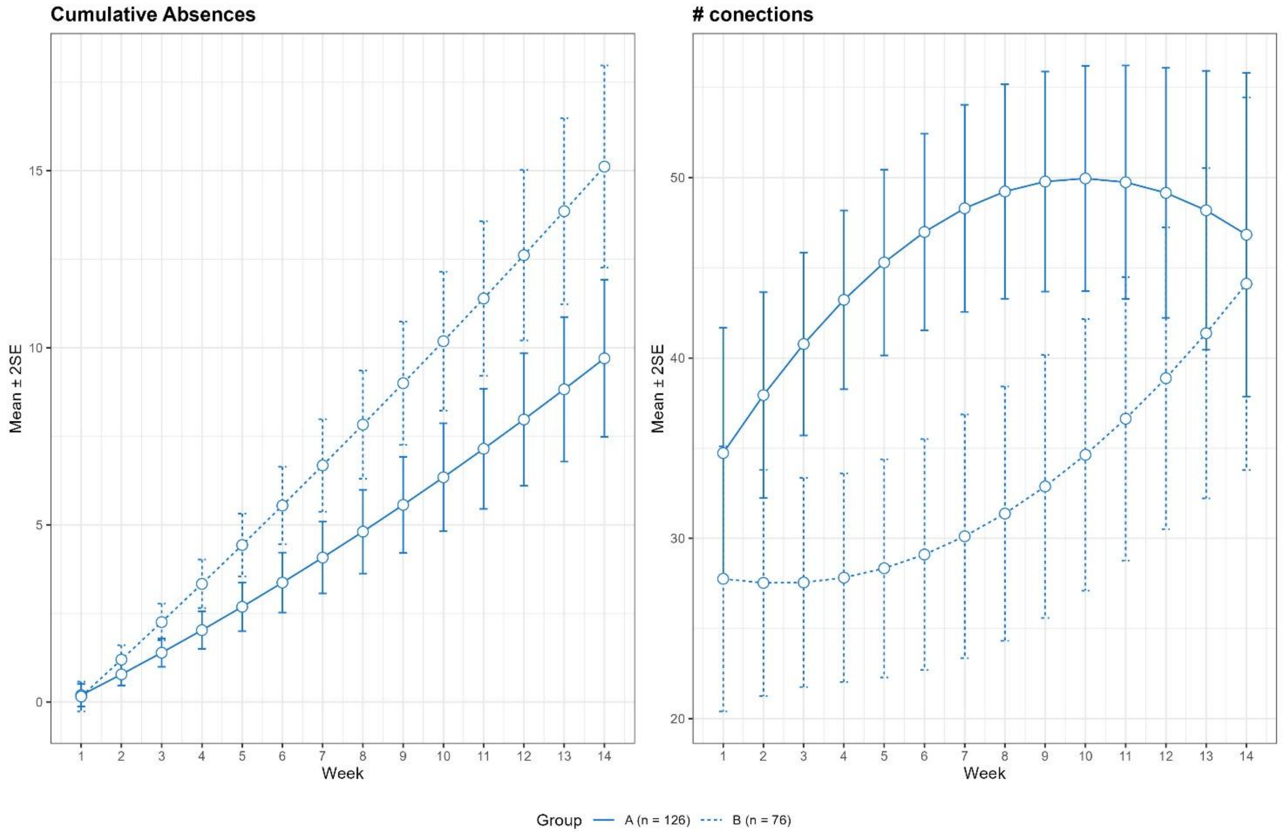
→ Comparatively smaller differences.



Results

- Motivational profiles, absenteeism, and activity:

- Cluster A (n = 126): ↓ cumulative absences ↑ Moodle activity.
- Cluster B (n = 76): ↑ cumulative absences ↓ Moodle activity.



Results

	Cluster A		Cluster B		t-test	95% CI Difference	
	M	SD	M	SD	t(df); p value	L.B.	U.B.
Objective Performance	6.47	1.84	6.65	1.68	-0.69(157); 0.49	-0.69	0.33
Subjective Performance	4.06	1.12	3.64	1.20	2.43(150); < 0.05	0.08	0.75
Absenteeism	9.56	11.84	14.87	14.15	-2.74(137); < 0.01	-9.13	-1.48
Planification	1.19	0.27	1.18	0.32	0.19(83); 0.85	-0.11	0.13
Teaching Methodology	1.27	0.56	1.52	0.81	-1.51(45); 0.14	-0.57	0.08
Learning Methodology	1.72	0.67	2.00	0.67	-2.14(87); < 0.05	-0.55	-0.02
Course Planning	1.20	0.41	1.66	0.85	-2.54(30); < 0.05	-0.83	-0.09
External Factors	1.22	0.29	1.63	0.73	-2.95(36); < 0.01	-0.68	-0.13

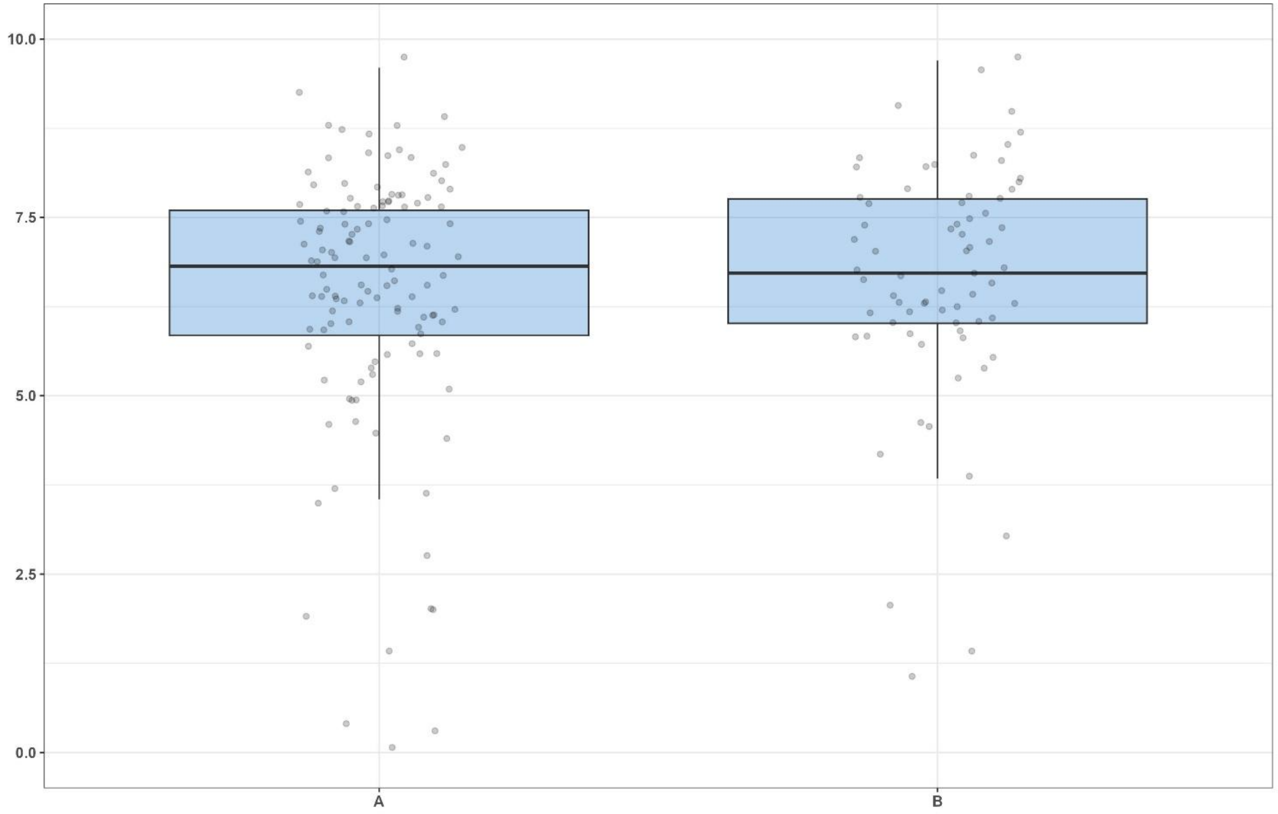
Results

- Predictive model for objective performance

Predictor	b	95% CI	Goodness of Fit
Intercept	6.47**	[6.14; 6.79]	
Cluster B	0.18	[-0.35; 0.71]	
			$R^2 = 0.002$
			95% CI [0.00; 0.03]

Results

- Prediction of objective performance.



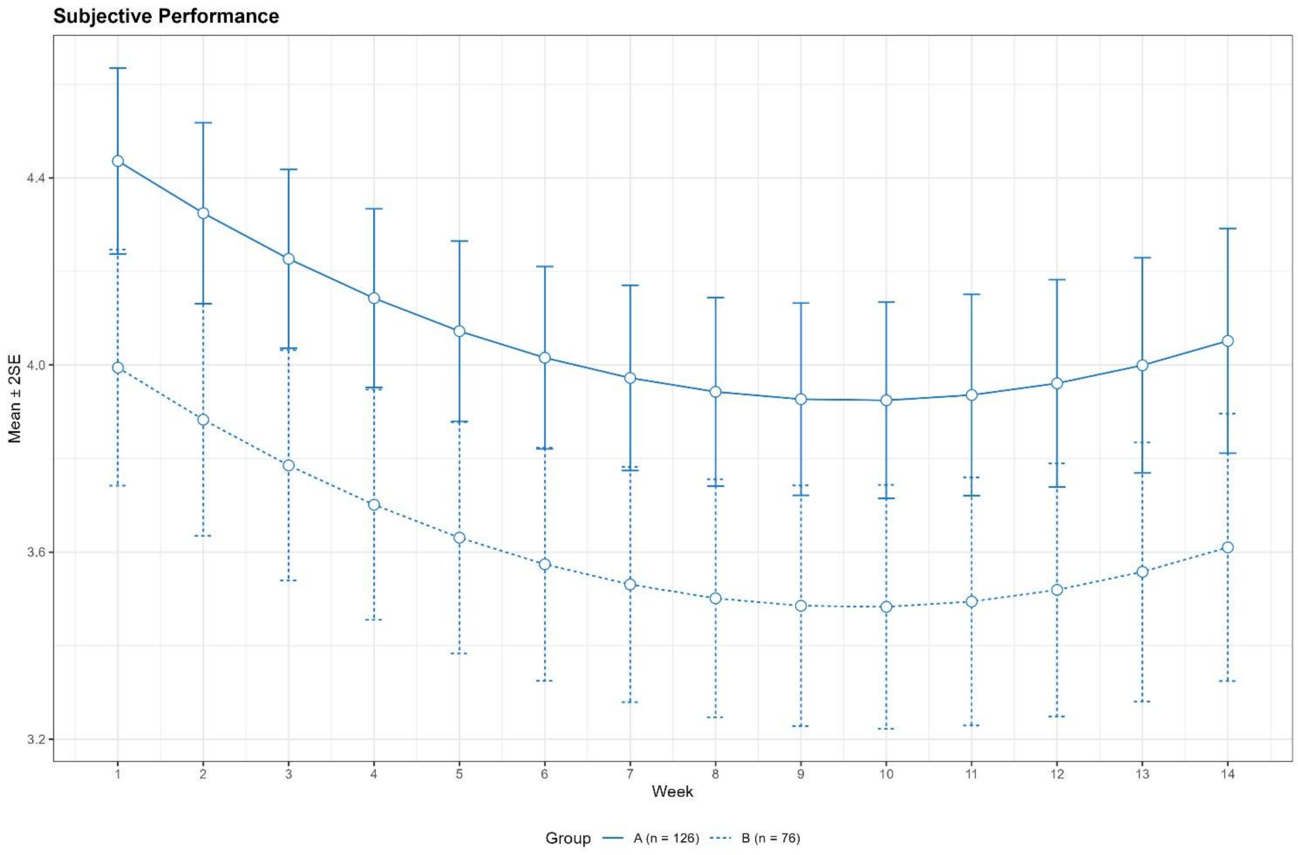
Results

- Predictive model for subjective performance

Predictor	b	95% CI	Goodness of Fit
Intercept	4,06**	[3,85; 4,26]	
Cluster B	-0,41*	[-0,74; -0,08]	
			R^2 = 0,03*
			95% CI [0,00; 0,09]

Results

- Prediction of subjective performance.



Discussion

Two motivational profiles clearly differentiated in terms of amotivation and intrinsic motivation.

Variable optimal solution.

Common profiles:
- Extrinsic–intrinsic motivation.
- External–internal regulation.
- Amotivation.

Predictive capacity of motivation-based models.

Conclusions

- **Motivational profiles based on individual trajectories.**
- **Motivational profiles and students' perceived achievement.**
- **Motivational profiles, absenteeism, and their causes.**
- **Designing strategies to reduce absenteeism and improve motivation.**

Thank you very much for your attention!

https://github.com/DLEIVA/HEAD2026